

Md. UZZAL CHOWDHURY

RESEARCH PERSONNEL

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Summary of Professional Experience

With nearly a decade of experience in research and evaluation across emergency and development settings, I specialize in Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability, and Learning (MEAL) with a strong foundation in statistics and data analysis. Holding a Master's in Statistics from the University of Dhaka, I have developed expertise in research design, survey tools, qualitative guideline development, data collection, analysis, and reporting. With hands-on experience in over 25 mixed-method research studies, I bring a strong track record in generating high-quality evidence to inform program design, drive implementation excellence, and shape policy decisions. Beyond research, I actively contribute to organizational priorities including CSP, DEI, GESI, humanitarian response, and staff well-being through cultural and sports engagement—demonstrating both analytical depth and a people-centered approach at SCI. His previous appointment before joining at SCI was as a Senior Statistician at BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health. I also worked as a Senior Teaching Fellow for the Biostatistics course of the MPH program. Previously, he also worked in the a2i program of the Prime Minister's office in Bangladesh. He has bachelors and master's degrees in Statistics, Biostatistics, and Informatics from the University of Dhaka, Bangladesh.

His work interests include climate change, urban and rural areas, marginalized communities such as brothel and Dalit groups, sexual and reproductive health and rights, children's and adolescents' health, index generation, and the application of behavioral science for service simplification.

Relevant Professional Experience (Role, Organization)

Year	Designation & Workplace
2022 - 2024	Technical Specialist- Research & Analysis, Save the Children International (SCI) I have been actively involved in mixed-method studies, enhancing my expertise in the research field. I have gained valuable experience in program development, implementation, and evaluation processes for internal research. My passion lies in generating high-quality evidence to support effective program implementation and influence policy decisions. I have led over 25 research studies, contributing to evidence generation, learning briefs, quarterly progress reports, annual report writing, proposal development, training facilitation, and dashboard design. Additionally, I support various organizational needs, including DEI and GESI initiatives, humanitarian efforts, and cultural and sports activities.
2018- 2022	Senior Statistician, BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health At BRAC JPGSPH, BRAC University, my primary responsibility lies in the Wellcome Trust project. This project focuses on identifying available secondary datasets and formulating policy scenarios to establish

pathways toward creating equitable, healthy cities in various locations, namely Dhaka, Beijing, Vancouver, Tehran, Accra, and London. Additionally, I coordinated and executed a nationwide survey on Sexually Reproductive Health (SRH) among Persons with Disabilities (PWDs) in Bangladesh. This initiative relies on the Disability Detection Survey database as a valuable resource. The survey aims to gather insights into the sufferings, knowledge, perceptions, and rights of PWDs regarding SRH. Furthermore, I was responsible for organizing and creating a draft report for the BRAC baseline research. This research primarily aimed to assess the well-being of Ready-Made garment (RMG) workers by utilizing a one-stop service center. In parallel to these engagements, I also contribute as a teaching fellow (TF) for the Biostatistics course in the MPH programme at JPGSPH. My responsibilities in this capacity involve assisting and supporting students pursuing their MPH degree and facilitating the STATA lab session. To get better experience in programme development, implementation, and evaluation conducted by INGOs with better opportunities.

2018- 2018 Policy Assistant, Access to information, Prime Minister’s Office, Bangladesh

As a Policy Assistant in a2i, my primary responsibility involved assisting with a2i's Skill for Employment team. This assistance aimed to facilitate the implementation of a skills development program across 100 economic zones in Bangladesh. Furthermore, I contributed to skills development initiatives benefiting 350,000 beneficiaries of the Ekti Bari Ekti Khamar (EBEK) projects. Additionally, I played a key role in district branding initiatives within the tourism sector, covering 37 upazilas. In addition to these responsibilities, I coordinated an apprenticeship program targeting unemployed youth in the formal sector. This involved organizing a nationwide Training of Trainers (ToT) workshop. Moreover, I drafted multiple Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) between government and private organizations. Furthermore, I had the opportunity to contribute to the design of the interface for the Skills Portal of Bangladesh, accessible at www.skills.gov.bd.

2015- 2018 Research Assistant, Access to information, UNDP & Prime Minister’s Office, Bangladesh

As a Research Assistant in a2i, my primary responsibility was to analyze survey data of various service simplification processes (SPS). Conducted monitoring and evaluation activities against the results and set measurable indicators for each team of a2i based on the annual working plan in line with the M&E Framework. Also assisted in drafting the Prime Minister’s Office’s reporting of different time periods (quarterly and year-end progress) and for the other donors (UNDP & USAID) on time and according to their requirements. Assisted in designing the interface of the Open Government Data (OGD) Portal of Bangladesh and the data management process of this portal, www.data.gov.bd, and also assisted in designing the citizen-centric mutation system in www.land.gov.bd by applying RCT in 46 Upazilas with the help of BIT.

Education (Result, Degree, and Institute)

Year

2014	Master of Science (M.Sc.) in Statistics, University of Dhaka
2013	Bachelor of Science (B.s) in Statistics, University of Dhaka

Technical Expertise & Software Proficiency

MEAL activities	Result Framework, Log-Frame, MEAL Budgeting, Project Management Methodology, Detailed Implementation Plan (DIP), Knowledge Management (KM), Collaborating, Learning & Adapting (CLA), Accountability, Management Information System
Data Collection Tool	KOBO Collect, Survey CTO, Survey Monkey, Qualtrics, Forms
Data Analysis	STATA, SPSS, EXCEL, Atlas TI, NVivo
Data visualization	Excel, R- Programming, SMART PLS, Canva
Data Dashboard	Power BI, Tableau

Donors worked with

USAID, WORLD BANK, UNICEF, DUTCH EMBASSY, IMPERIAL COLLEGE, LEGO FOUNDATION, INNOVATION FUND, HEMPEL FOUNDATION, H&M, IDRC, SC KOREA, JAPAN, UK, BRUNEL UNIVERSITY, MONASH UNIVERSITY.

Publications:

- Rahman, S, Haque, S.M, **Chowdhury, M.U**, et. al –(2024)Bangladesh - Eastern flood needs assessment report, September 2024.
<https://reliefweb.int/report/bangladesh/bangladesh-eastern-flood-needs-assessment-report-september-2024>
- Lim, I. E., Mahmud, I., **Chowdhury, M. U.**, Kaiser, A., Bonny, F. A., Akanbonga, S., & Hasan, M. T. (2023). Early Childhood Development (ECD) in Ghana: Assessing the Status and Determinants of the Literacy–Numeracy, Physical, Social–Emotional, and Learning Domains. International Journal of Early Childhood.
<https://doi.org/10.1007/S13158-023-00349-Y>
- Akanbonga, S., Hasan, T., **Chowdhury, MU.**, Kaiser, A., Akter Bonny, F., Lim, I. E., & Mahmud, I. (2023). Infant and young child feeding practices and associated socioeconomic and demographic factors among children aged 6–23 months in Ghana: Findings from Ghana Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey, 2017–2018. PLOS ONE, 18(6), e0286055. <https://doi.org/10.1371/JOURNAL.PONE.0286055>
- Urme SA, Radia MA, Alam R, **Chowdhury MU**, Hasan S, Ahmed S, Sara HH, Islam MS, Jerin DT, Hema PS, Rahman M, Islam AKM, Hasan MT, Quayyum Z. Dhaka landfill waste practices: addressing urban pollution and health hazards. Buildings and Cities. 2021; 2(1):700–716. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5334/bc.108>
- Azmi R, **Chowdhury MU**, Sara HH, Biswas SC, Ahsan S, Mowri SS, Sultana R, Hasan MT, Rashid SF. Factors influencing choices for early marriage in urban informal settlements of Bangladesh. Progress in Development Studies. 2021; 21(3):298-320. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1177/14649934211023003>
- Hasan MT, Amin A, **Chowdhury MU**, Islam KF, Huq SM, Parvin R, Ahmed SJ, Ali ML, Rashid SF. Health sufferings, healthcare-seeking behavior, awareness about health insurance, and health-related rights of ready-made garments workers in Bangladesh: Findings from a cross-sectional study. J Occup Health. 2021; 63(1): e12256. doi: 10.1002/1348-9585.12256. PMID: 34382289; PMCID: PMC8357819.
- **Chowdhury MU**, Mohosin AB, Ahmed AI, Madhu B, Hasan TM, Raz S, Bonny FA, Hasan TA, Rashid SF (2020). A working paper on knowledge Regarding Sexual and

Reproductive Health (SRH) among persons with disabilities in Bangladesh: Findings from a nationwide mixed-method study.

- Hasan MT, Amin A, **Chowdhury MU**, Rabbany MA, Rashid SF (2020). Gender-based perception and differentials of COVID-19: Findings from Rapid Surveys. <https://r.bangladeshhealthwatch.org/research/details/MTAwMDAyMjI=>
- Urme SA, Radia MA, Alam R, **Chowdhury MU**, Hasan S, Ahmed S, Sara HH, Islam MS, Jerin DT, Hema PS, Rahman M, Islam AKM, Hasan MT, Quayyum Z (2022). Use of PPE, Health Sufferings and Health Care Seeking Pattern of Municipal Solid Waste Handlers in Dhaka City: An Exploratory study. 6th International Conference on Public Health (ICOPH 2020)

Research Expeditions:

- **2025**, Informal Settlements Survey in DNCC, DSCC, and Chattogram City Corporations, **Principal Investigator**.
- **2024**, Strengthening local leadership to promote resilience, recovery, and effective response for the vulnerable communities in Sylhet region and other districts in Bangladesh- BHA Baseline Study, **Principal Investigator**
- **2024**, Understanding the impact of skills training on the livelihoods on adolescents and youths of Cox's Bazar host community, **Principal Investigator**
- **2024**, A Baseline study of Mamota Project, **Principal Investigator**
- **2024**, Phased-out study of Providing Opportunities for Vulnerable Children through Education Program (PVCEP), **Principal Investigator**
- **2024**, Child Climate Resilience and Forced Displacement in Bangladesh: Unravelling Factors, Assessing Impact, and Guiding Interventions, **Principal Investigator**
- **2024**, Ensuring Access to Safe, Equitable, Inclusive Learning Opportunities for Adolescents, Youths in the Camps and Rohingya Community in Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh- A Baseline Study, **Principal Investigator**
- **2023**, Baseline report of Education Cannot Wait for MYRP project in the Rohingya and host community, **Principal Investigator**
- **2022**, Multisectoral Needs Assessment report- 2022 in Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh, **Co-investigator**, Internal study of Save the Children.
- **2022**, Hypertension and Obesity prevalence in Bangladesh. How large is the iceberg? **Co-investigator**, Internal study of Save the Children
- **2022**, DANIDA SPA Baseline report on integrated education and child protection services for vulnerable Rohingya Refugee children, **Co-investigator**, Internal study of Save the Children.
- **2022**, Endline evaluation of Safe Back to School Community level Case Management (SB2S CCM) Project, **Principal Investigator**; Internal study of Save the Children
- **2022**, Exploring the Impact of COVID-19 on Children's Education and Women's Livelihoods at Urban Slums, **Co-investigator**, Internal study of Save the Children.
- **2021**, Impact of Nutritional Corner in BRAC Health Facilities in the Rohingya Refugee Camps: A Cost-Effectiveness Analysis, **Co-Investigator** funded by BRAC.
- **2020**, A baseline of the status of SRHR among Women and Girls with Disabilities (WGWDs) facing violence in Bangladesh, **Co-Investigator** funded by ARROW.
- **2019-2020**, Formative research, Baseline Research, Operational Research, and Endline Research on disrupting cross-border trafficking Networks (Bangladesh) Project, **Co-Investigator** funded by BRAC.
- **2019**, Success Factors, Challenges, and Future Priorities for Ensuring Sexual and Reproductive Health of Rohingya Women and Adolescent Girls in Refugee Camps in Cox's Bazar, (Bangladesh), **Co-Investigator**, funded by WHO.
- **2019**, Advancing inclusive and resilient development targeted at the urban poor for the BRAC Urban Development Programme (UDP), funded by ADB.
- **2018-2020**, Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) of Persons with Disabilities in Bangladesh **Co-Investigator**, funded by the Dutch Government.
- **2018**, Baseline research for the BRAC ready-made garments workers well-being project, **Co-Investigator**, funded by BRAC.

- **2018-2021**, Pathways to Equitable Healthy Cities, Co-Investigator, funded by Wellcome Trust.

Research/ Program Grants

- **2023**, Child Climate Resilience and Forced Displacement in Bangladesh: Unravelling Factors, Assessing Impact, and Guiding Interventions (USD 20,725), Principal Investigator, funded by MDI, SCI.
- **2022**, Baseline Study to Assess Primary School Dropout Issue in Selected Districts of Bangladesh amid the COVID-19 Pandemic (USD 48,000), **Co-Investigator** funded by BRAC.
- **2020**, A baseline of the status of SRHR among Women and Girls with Disabilities (WGWDs) facing violence in Bangladesh, **Co-Investigator** funded by ARROW.
- **2019-2020**, Formative research, Baseline Research, Operational Research, and Endline Research on disrupting cross-border trafficking Networks (Bangladesh) Project, (USD 98,170), **Co-Investigator** funded by BRAC.
- **2019**, Success Factors, Challenges, and Future Priorities for Ensuring Sexual and Reproductive Health of Rohingya Women and Adolescent Girls in Refugee Camps in Cox's Bazar, (Bangladesh), (USD 24,441), **Co-Investigator**, funded by WHO.
- **2018**, Baseline research for the BRAC ready-made garments workers well-being project (USD 26,885), **Co-Investigator**, funded by BRAC.

Monitoring & Evaluation:

- **2015-2018**, Conduct monitoring and evaluation activities against the results and set measurable indicators in line with the M&E Framework, regularly collect the performance data/ information (through the application of qualitative and quantitative methods and tools), analyze the data/ information for producing periodic monitoring reports and status updates in line with set targets in the M&E framework of a2i's (access to information) project, prime minister's office, Bangladesh.

Teaching Activities

- **2021-2022**, Senior Teaching Fellow, Biostatistics (MPH- 521) BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health, BRAC University, Dhaka, Bangladesh.
- **2020-2021**, Co-supervisor of Summative Learning Project (SLP) of 6 Master of Public Health (MPH) Students, BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health
- **2020-2021**, Teaching Fellow, Biostatistics (MPH- 521) BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health, BRAC University, Dhaka, Bangladesh.
- **2019-2020**, Co-supervisor of Summative Learning Project (SLP) of 5 Master of Public Health (MPH) Students, BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health
- **2019-2020**, Teaching Fellow, Biostatistics (MPH- 521) BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health.
- **2018-2019**, Teaching Fellow, Biostatistics (MPH- 521) BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health.

Training Facilitation

- **2024**, Training workshop on Building Ethical and Digital Data Excellence: KoboCollect design
- **2024**, Advanced Training on Research Methodology & Data Analysis: Using SPSS, STATA, & Atlas TI; Two inclusive days training for the BHPI (Bangladesh Health Professions Institute) professionals at CRP (Centre for the Rehabilitation of the Paralysed) in Bangladesh
- **2022**, Quantitative Data Analysis Using STATA (3 inclusive days)
- **2020**, Basic Quantitative Research Methods, Data Analysis, and Report Writing using STATA (6 days training for BRAC international professionals)
- **2019**, Quantitative Data Analysis using STATA (5 days training for professionals)

Learning & Training Received

- **2025**, Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning for Development Professionals (**MEAL DPro**), using e-Learning platform.
- **2025**, Emergency in Response Training (ERT)
- **2023**, ToT on Gender Equity and Social Inclusion
- **2022**, Project Management Methodology (**PMM**) **Flex**, SCI
- **2021**, Research ethics, e-learning course, London School of Hygiene & Tropical Medicine
- **2021**, Training on Urban Health in Bangladesh
Venue: Department of Population Sciences, Building, University of Dhaka (29th December 2021- 2nd January 2022)
- **2019**, R for Data Analytics, Institute of Statistical Research and Training (ISRT), University of Dhaka (25th September- 30th October)
- **2018**, DHS eLearning survey sampling training course- Summer- 2018 (1st July- 30th August)
- **2017**, **Professional Training on Evidence-Based Policy Making & Program Design**, IPA, J-PAL, CLEAR and IFMR, UNDP, Bangladesh (3 days inclusive training)
- **2017**, I- Data Studio Training Workshop, Flowminder, Pulse Lab Jakarta, Datakind SG, Petabencana, Akvo, Social cops, The Engine Room, Pulse Lab, and GovLab, UNDP Regional Hub, Thailand (29th March- 31st March 2017).

References

- **Reefat Bin Sattar**, Director - PDQ, **Save the Children International in Bangladesh**, House CWN (A) 35, Road 43, Gulshan 2, Dhaka 1212, Bangladesh Email: reefat.sattar@savethechildren.org M: [+880-1777763988](tel:+880-1777763988)
- **Md.Tanvir Hasan, PhD**
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Co-Director, Centre of Excellence for Urban Equity & Health (CUEH) **BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health, BRAC University**
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- **Dr. Ramiz Uddin**, Head of Experimentation, AccLab, **UNDP - Bangladesh Country Office**, Email: ramizuddin@gmail.com , ramiz.uddin@undp.org, M: [+8801714118548](tel:+8801714118548)